

FIGHTER PLANES

Small, fast, and agile, fighter planes are designed for attacking other aircraft. The first fighters appeared during World War I. Today's planes have highly sophisticated tracking and weapons systems.



SOPWITH PUP



SOPWITH F.1 CAMEL



BRISTOL BULLDOG



P-38 LIGHTNING



MESSERSCHMITT ME262



NIEUPORT 17



FOKKER DR.1



SUPERMARINE SPITFIRE



P-51 MUSTANG



F-86 SABRE



ROYAL AIRCRAFT FACTORY S.E.5A



SOPWITH DOLPHIN



A6M ZERO



YAKOVLEV YAK-9



F-4 PHANTOM II



HAWKER HUNTER

BOMBERS AND STRIKE AIRCRAFT

The role of these aircraft is to strike ground and sea targets. Heavy bombers carry out long-range strategic missions. Low-flying strike aircraft can attack battlefield targets, such as tanks and troops, with great precision.



ROYAL AIRCRAFT FACTORY B.E.2C



DE HAVILLAND MOSQUITO



B-25 MITCHELL



B-52 STRATOFORTRESS



VICKERS VIMY



AVRO LANCASTER



JUNKERS JU 87B



AVRO 698 VULCAN



A-4 SKYHAWK



B-17 FLYING FORTRESS



VICKERS WELLINGTON X



B-58A HUSTLER

Aircraft

Aviation has come a long way since the first powered aircraft flight took place in 1903. Today, huge planes can carry hundreds of passengers halfway around the world, while supersonic fighter jets can fly faster than the speed of sound.

HOW PLANES FLY

All aeroplanes have wings and an engine. In order to fly, a plane must engage in a "tug-of-war" between the forces of lift versus weight, and thrust versus drag.

